

TMS, DMS and CMS Usage Guide for Falcon BMS 4.38.1

Carlos “Metal” Nader

Version 0.3.3.0+20260202 | Progress: Chapters 3/7 | Tables Chapter 5 and Chapter 4 | January
2026

Contents

List of HOTAS Tables	ii
1 TMS – Target Management Switch	1
1.1 Concept and general behaviour	2
1.1.1 Physical location and actuation	2
1.1.2 Directional functions (general overview)	2
1.1.3 TMS and Sensor of Interest (SOI)	3
1.1.4 TMS timing and press duration logic	3
1.2 TMS and Situational Awareness displays	5
1.2.1 TMS with HSD as SOI	5
1.2.2 TMS with FCR in search modes (pre-designation)	5
1.2.3 TMS actions with HSD as SOI (Table)	6
1.2.4 TMS actions in FCR search modes (Table)	6
1.3 TMS in Air-to-Air	7
1.4 TMS in Air-to-Ground	8
1.4.1 TMS with FCR in A-G radar modes (GM/GMT/SEA)	8
1.4.2 TMS with Targeting Pod (TGP) as SOI	8
1.4.3 TMS with HUD/HMCS MARK function	9
1.5 TMS in weapon employment	11
1.5.1 TMS in AGM-65 Maverick employment	11
1.5.2 TMS in DTOS (Dive Toss) deliveries	11
1.5.3 TMS in IAM-VIS (JSOW/JDAM visual)	12
1.5.4 TMS in CCIP/CCRP deliveries	12
1.5.5 TMS in HARM employment	13
1.6 TMS – Block and variant notes	14
1.6.1 Block-specific TMS differences	14
1.6.2 IFF (AIFF) configuration	14
1.6.3 AGM-65L (Laser Maverick) specifics	14
1.6.4 Training mission recommendations by block	15

List of HOTAS Tables

Chapter 1

TMS – Target Management Switch

The **Target Management Switch (TMS)** is a four-direction spring-loaded hat switch located on the control stick's right side. It serves as the pilot's primary hands-on interface for target acquisition, designation, tracking management, and rejection across both air-to-air and air-to-ground employment. Unlike the DMS, which manages *which display receives control inputs* (Sensor of Interest), the TMS manages *what the sensors are doing with targets*.

TMS behavior is **highly context-sensitive**. The same physical input—for example, a short press forward (TMS Up)—can command:

- **Target designation** in FCR RWS (air-to-air search → SAM).
- **Spotlight search** when held longer than 1 second in RWS/TWS.
- **Ground stabilization** in A-G visual modes (DTOS, AGM-65 VIS, MARK).
- **Fixed Target Track (FTT)** in A-G radar modes (GM, GMT, SEA).
- **HMCS slaving** when held >0.5 seconds in specific A-G visual contexts.

This chapter systematically documents TMS behavior across all operational contexts, organized by:

1. **General TMS concept and timing** ([Section 1.1](#))
2. **TMS with SA displays** (HSD, FCR non-tracking modes) ([Section 1.2](#))
3. **TMS in Air-to-Air** (FCR tracking, ACM, TWS, IFF) ([Section 1.3](#))
4. **TMS in Air-to-Ground** (FCR GM/GMT/SEA, TGP, MARK) ([Section 1.4](#))
5. **TMS in weapon employment** (AGM-65, HARM, DTOS, IAM-VIS, CCIP/CCRP) ([Section 1.5](#))
6. **Block/variant notes** ([Section 1.6](#))

The guide follows the same structure established in Chapters 4 (DMS) and 5 (CMS): narrative explanations provide context and rationale, while **hotastable** environments present mode-specific actions in tabular format with cross-references to Dash-34 sections and BMS training missions.

Critical reminder: TMS commands are routed to whichever sensor or display is currently SOI (Sensor of Interest). If the pilot intends to designate a target on the FCR but SOI is on the HSD, TMS Up will act on the HSD cursor instead. Understanding SOI logic (Chapter 2, Section ?? and Chapter 3, Section ??) is essential to mastering TMS usage.

1.1 Concept and general behaviour

The Target Management Switch (TMS) is the pilot’s primary tool for hands-on target handling. Its four directions—Up, Down, Left, Right—control different aspects of target acquisition, tracking, and management depending on the current master mode, sensor configuration, and SOI (Sensor of Interest).

1.1.1 Physical location and actuation

TMS is a spring-loaded four-way hat switch on the control stick, positioned on the right side of the stick grip. The switch returns to center when released. Two actuation types are recognized by the avionics:

- **Short press:** Actuate and release immediately (<0.5 seconds).
- **Long press / hold:** Actuate and hold for ≥ 0.5 seconds (some functions require >1.0 seconds).

The distinction between short and long press is critical: the same direction can invoke completely different functions depending on press duration. For example:

- **TMS Up short:** Designate target in FCR RWS (enter SAM).
- **TMS Up held $>1s$:** Initiate spotlight search in RWS/TWS.
- **TMS Up held $>0.5s$:** Slave MARK cue or TD box to HMCS in A-G visual modes.

1.1.2 Directional functions (general overview)

Each TMS direction has context-dependent functions:

TMS Up (Forward): The most frequently used direction. Primary functions include:

- **Air-to-Air:** Target designation (RWS $\rightarrow$ SAM, SAM $\rightarrow$ STT), spotlight search (when held), ACM BORE slaving to HMCS.
- **Air-to-Ground:** Ground stabilization (DTOS, AGM-65 VIS, MARK), Fixed Target Track (FTT) in GM/GMT/SEA, HMCS slaving (when held $>0.5s$).

TMS Down (Aft): Primarily used for **Return-to-Search (RTS)** functions:

- **Air-to-Air:** Break radar lock, step back through tracking modes (STT $\rightarrow$ SAM $\rightarrow$ RWS), reject ACM targets.
- **Air-to-Ground:** Reject ground targets, cancel FTT, un-slave HMCS cues, return to pre-designate state.

TMS Left: Context-specific functions:

- **IFF interrogation:** SCAN mode (short press $<0.6s$), LOS mode (long press $\geq 0.6s$).
- **Other contexts:** Limited use; primarily reserved for IFF in BMS 4.38.1.

TMS Right: Target stepping and mode transitions:

- **Air-to-Air:** Step bug to next priority target (short press), transition to TWS (long press >1s), toggle between primary/secondary in DT SAM.
- **Air-to-Ground:** Cycle sighting point options (STPT/TGT → OA1 → OA2 → IP → RP → SP).

1.1.3 TMS and Sensor of Interest (SOI)

TMS commands are **always routed to the current SOI**. If SOI is on the FCR, TMS commands act on FCR targets and radar modes. If SOI is on the HSD, TMS commands act on HSD cursor and datalink targets. If SOI is on the HUD (A-G visual modes), TMS commands act on HUD/HMCS symbology (TD box, MARK cue, etc.).

Example 1: Air-to-Air FCR SOI Pilot is in A-A master mode with FCR as SOI. ACQ cursor is over a search target. TMS Up (short) → FCR designates target, enters SAM submode, begins tracking. SOI remains on FCR.

Example 2: Air-to-Air HSD SOI Pilot is in A-A master mode with HSD as SOI (DMS Down toggled SOI to HSD). ACQ cursor is over a datalink target. TMS Up (short) → HSD designates datalink target as PDLT (Pre-Designated Lead Track). FCR is unaffected.

Example 3: Air-to-Ground HUD SOI Pilot is in A-G master mode, DTOS submode, HUD as SOI. TD box is slewed over target. TMS Up (short) → TD box ground-stabilizes on target. SOI auto-transitions to TGP or WPN MFD page if available.

Critical implication: If the pilot loses track of which display is SOI, TMS commands may not produce the expected result. For instance, attempting to designate an FCR target while SOI is on the HSD will result in HSD cursor action instead of FCR designation. Understanding and controlling SOI (via DMS Up/Down, see [Section 1](#)) is prerequisite to effective TMS usage.

1.1.4 TMS timing and press duration logic

Press duration thresholds:

- **<0.5 seconds:** Short press. Most common designation, rejection, and stepping functions.
- **≥ 0.5 seconds:** Medium-long press. HMCS slaving in A-G visual modes (MARK, DTOS, AGM-65 VIS).
- **>1.0 seconds:** Long press/hold. Spotlight search (RWS/TWS), TWS transition (TMS Right), ACM BORE HMCS slaving.

The avionics distinguish these thresholds automatically. Pilots must develop muscle memory for:

- **Quick tap:** Designation, rejection, stepping (most frequent use).
- **Half-second hold:** HMCS slaving (A-G visual).
- **Full-second hold:** Spotlight search, TWS entry.

Training recommendation: Practice timing in BMS Training Mission 18 (BARCAP) for A-A spotlight search, and Mission 25 (DTOS) for A-G HMCS slaving. See Section ?? and Section ?? for mode-specific tables.

1.2 TMS and Situational Awareness displays

This section covers TMS behavior when SOI is on displays primarily used for situational awareness rather than direct target engagement: the Horizontal Situation Display (HSD) and the FCR in non-tracking search modes (before target designation).

1.2.1 TMS with HSD as SOI

When HSD is SOI (typically via DMS Down in A-A or NAV modes), TMS commands interact with HSD cursor for datalink target management, steerpoint selection, and threat ring display.

TMS Up (HSD SOI)

- Cursor over datalink track: Designates track as PDLT (Pre-Designated Lead Track).
 - PDLT displays as octagon symbol on HSD.
 - PDLT track data (range, aspect, altitude) appears on HUD if available.
 - Used for flight coordination: “My PDLT, your PDLT” target deconfliction.
- Cursor over steerpoint symbol: Selects steerpoint as active.

TMS Down (HSD SOI)

- Removes PDLT octagon designation.
- If cursor over pre-planned threat with threat ring visible, first press removes threat ring; second press removes PDLT.

TMS Right (HSD SOI)

- Steps PDLT through datalink tracks (bottom-to-top, right-to-left sequence).
- Allows rapid cycling through multiple contacts without cursor slew.

Operational context (A-A)

PDLT designation in A-A master mode provides:

- Target prioritization in dense datalink picture (8+ contacts).
- Flight coordination: Lead designates PDLT, wingman takes non-PDLT targets.
- Tactical picture management: PDLT on HVT (High Value Target) for kill priority.
- AWACS/GCI integration: Controller assigns targets, pilot designates via PDLT.

Operational context (NAV)

HSD in NAV mode used for steerpoint management and navigation SA. TMS Up selects steerpoints hands-on without ICP interaction.

Reference: HSD datalink operations in TO 1F-16CM-34-1-1 §2.4.3.7.2.1. Link 16 PPLI in §2.4.3.6.1.4.

See Table ?? for detailed HSD TMS actions.

1.2.2 TMS with FCR in search modes (pre-designation)

Before target designation, the FCR operates in search modes: RWS (Range-While-Search), ULS (Up-Look Search), or VSR (Velocity Search with Ranging). In these modes, TMS commands are used

to:

- **Designate search targets:** Transition from search → SAM (or directly to STT in VSR).
- **Initiate spotlight search:** Temporarily increase scan resolution for target sorting.
- **Transition to TWS:** Enter Track-While-Scan mode for multi-target tracking.

TMS Up (short press): Designates the search target under the ACQ cursor. FCR enters SAM (Situation Awareness Mode) and begins tracking the designated target while maintaining search coverage.

TMS Up (held >1 second): Initiates **spotlight search:** a temporary 4-bar $\pm 10^\circ$ scan pattern centered on the ACQ cursor. When TMS is released, if a target is under the cursor, FCR attempts acquisition. Spotlight search is useful for resolving closely-grouped targets before designation.

TMS Right (held >1 second): Transitions FCR from RWS/ULS → TWS (Track-While-Scan). Any currently bugged target is retained. This allows the pilot to build multi-target track files hands-on without using MFD OSBs.

Operational note: These TMS functions are available only when FCR is SOI. If SOI has migrated to HSD or TGP, TMS commands will not affect FCR search modes. Use DMS Down to toggle SOI back to FCR if needed.

See Table ?? for FCR search mode TMS actions.

1.2.3 TMS actions with HSD as SOI (Table)

[PLACEHOLDER: Table to be developed showing TMS Up/Down/Left/Right actions with HSD as SOI, covering PDLT designation, steerpoint selection, threat ring management. Reference Dash-34 HSD chapter and relevant training missions.]

1.2.4 TMS actions in FCR search modes (Table)

[PLACEHOLDER: Table to be developed showing TMS actions in RWS, ULS, VSR before target designation. Include spotlight search, designation to SAM, TWS transition. Reference Dash-34 §2.3.1.5.3.3, §2.3.1.5.4, §2.3.1.5.6. Training: Mission 18 (BARCAP).]

1.3 TMS in Air-to-Air

1.4 TMS in Air-to-Ground

This section covers TMS behavior when employing A-G sensors for target acquisition and designation: FCR in GM/GMT/SEA modes, Targeting Pod (TGP), and HUD/HMCS MARK function.

1.4.1 TMS with FCR in A-G radar modes (GM/GMT/SEA)

When FCR is in Ground Moving Target (GMT), Ground Mapping (GM), or Sea modes, TMS commands control target designation, Fixed Target Track (FTT), and sighting point management.

TMS Up in GM/GMT/SEA:

- **Pre-designation (cursor over radar return):** Ground-stabilizes cursor, establishes FTT (Fixed Target Track). FCR ranges to cursor position. SOI auto-transitions to WPN or TGP MFD page (if available).
- **Post-designation (FTT active):** Refines FTT lock (implementation varies by radar mode).

TMS Down in GM/GMT/SEA:

- **Drops FTT:** Returns cursor to previous position before FTT attempt. Radar resumes search.

TMS Right in GM/GMT/SEA:

- **Cycles sighting point options:** STPT/TGT → OA1 → OA2 → IP → RP → SP (Snowplow). Same rotary as OSB 10 on FCR GM page.

TMS Left in GM/GMT/SEA:

- **IFF interrogation:** Same SCAN/LOS logic as A-A (if AIFF configured for A-G). Limited operational use in A-G contexts.

Operational context: FCR A-G modes are critical in IMC (Instrument Meteorological Conditions), night ops, or pre-planned CCRP deliveries. TMS Up designates radar-significant targets (buildings, bridges, vehicles in GMT) for weapons employment. FTT provides continuous ranging for accurate CCRP solutions.

See Table ?? for FCR A-G TMS actions.

1.4.2 TMS with Targeting Pod (TGP) as SOI

When the Targeting Pod (TGP) is SOI, TMS commands manage target designation, track mode transitions, and handoff to weapons (AGM-65, LGBs).

TMS Up with TGP SOI:

- **Pre-track (TGP in AREA mode):** Initiates POINT track on crosshair position. TGP locks onto thermal contrast at crosshair.
- **POINT track active:** Confirms lock, stabilizes track. SOI may auto-transition to WPN page (weapon-dependent).

TMS Down with TGP SOI:

- **POINT track active:** Breaks track, returns TGP to AREA mode. Crosshair returns to slew mode.

TMS Right with TGP SOI:

- **Cycles sighting point options:** Same STPT/TGT → OA1 → OA2 → IP → RP → SP rotary as FCR.

TMS Left with TGP SOI:

- **Cycles TGP FOV:** $WFOV \iff NFOV$ (Wide/Narrow Field of View). Same as OSB on TGP page.

Operational context: TGP provides visual/IR target identification and designation in A-G. TMS Up to POINT track is prerequisite for LGB lasing and AGM-65 handoff. TGP SOI is typical in PRE (pre-planned) weapon deliveries and target confirmation before VIS (visual) attack.

See Table ?? for TGP TMS actions.

1.4.3 TMS with HUD/HMCS MARK function

The MARK function creates markpoints (latitude/longitude coordinates) for navigation or target reference. TMS commands slave MARK cue to HMCS, ground-stabilize, and store markpoints.

TMS Up in MARK mode:

- **First press (held >0.5s):** Slaves MARK LOS circle to HMCS aiming cross. Circle moves with pilot head movement.
- **Second press (short):** Ground-stabilizes MARK LOS circle at current HMCS position.
- **Third press (short):** Stores MARK data as markpoint in steerpoint database. Markpoint can be sequenced as steerpoint.

TMS Down in MARK mode:

- **After first TMS Up:** Re-slaves MARK LOS circle to HMCS aiming cross (cancels ground-stabilization).
- **After second TMS Down:** Re-slaves MARK LOS circle to FPM on HUD (returns to HUD MARK mode, no HMCS).

Operational context: MARK is used for:

- **Target marking:** Pilot visually identifies target (e.g., SAM site), creates markpoint, shares coordinates with flight.
- **Navigation reference:** Mark visual features (rivers, buildings) for navigation in low-altitude ingress.
- **SEAD/CAS:** Mark enemy positions for coordination with FAC or wingmen.

HMCS MARK (TMS Up >0.5s) allows marking targets outside HUD FOV, critical in dynamic CAS or visual recon.

See Table ?? for MARK TMS actions.

[PLACEHOLDER: The following tables will be developed:]

1.5 TMS in weapon employment

This section documents TMS behavior during active weapon employment: AGM-65 Maverick, DTOS (Dive Toss), IAM-VIS (JSOW/JDAM visual), CCIP/CCRP, and HARM.

1.5.1 TMS in AGM-65 Maverick employment

AGM-65 Maverick (D/G/L variants) uses TMS for seeker designation, HMCS slaving, and handoff coordination.

AGM-65 VIS (Visual) submode:

- **TMS Up (first, held >0.5s):** Slaves TD box to HMCS aiming cross (if HMCS available). TD box blanked from HUD.
- **TMS Up (second, short):** Ground-stabilizes TD box at HMCS position. SOI auto-transitions to WPN MFD page. Maverick seeker slaved to TD box.
- **TMS Up (third, short, WPN SOI):** Commands Maverick self-track. GPI (Gimbal Position Indicator) shows solid square when track valid.

TMS Down in AGM-65 VIS:

- **After HMCS slaving:** Un-slaves TD box from HMCS, returns to FPM.
- **After designation:** Rejects target, returns HUD to pre-designate state. SOI returns to HUD.

AGM-65 PRE (Pre-planned) submode:

- **TMS Up with FCR SOI:** Commands FTT on radar return. SOI auto-transitions to WPN page. Maverick seeker slaved to FTT position.
- **TMS Up with WPN SOI:** Stabilizes Maverick LOS using steerpoint elevation/barometric altitude (if FTT not available).

Operational context: AGM-65 employment requires precise seeker designation. VIS mode (TMS Up sequence) is used when target is visually identifiable. PRE mode (FTT) is used for pre-planned targets with poor visual signature but good radar return (e.g., buildings, bridges).

See Table ?? for AGM-65 TMS actions.

1.5.2 TMS in DTOS (Dive Toss) deliveries

DTOS (Dive Toss) combines visual target designation with automatic ballistic computation. TMS commands manage TD box slaving, ground-stabilization, and HMCS integration.

TMS Up in DTOS (HUD SOI):

- **First press (held >0.5s):** Slaves TD box to HMCS aiming cross. TD box blanked from HUD.
- **Second press (short):** Ground-stabilizes TD box at HMCS position (post-designate mode). Pilot can refine via CURSOR, then second TMS Up stores designation.
- **Short press (no HMCS):** Ground-stabilizes TD box at current HUD position (standard DTOS designation).

TMS Down in DTOS:

- **After HMCS slaving:** Un-slaves TD box from HMCS, returns to FPM.
- **After designation:** Rejects target, returns to pre-designate mode. TD box returns to FPM.

Operational context: DTOS is used for visual dive or toss deliveries of Mk-82/84, CBU, IAMs in DTOS mode. HMCS slaving (TMS Up >0.5s) allows designation of targets outside HUD FOV, critical in high-angle attacks or mountainous terrain.

See Table ?? for DTOS TMS actions.

1.5.3 TMS in IAM-VIS (JSOW/JDAM visual)

IAM-VIS (Improved Air Munitions Visual) uses similar TD box logic to DTOS but for JSOW/JDAM visual deliveries.

TMS Up in IAM-VIS: Similar to DTOS: ground-stabilizes TD box, HMCS slaving when held >0.5s. Weapon delivery cues (azimuth steering line, solution cue) appear after designation.

TMS Down in IAM-VIS: Rejects target, returns to pre-designate. TD box returns to FPM.

Operational context: IAM-VIS is used when JSOW/JDAM target is visually identifiable but not suitable for GPS-only delivery (e.g., moving target, last-minute target change). TMS Up designates visual aimpoint; weapon guides to TD box position.

See Table ?? for IAM-VIS TMS actions.

1.5.4 TMS in CCIP/CCRP deliveries

CCIP (Continuously Computed Impact Point) and CCRP (Continuously Computed Release Point) are ballistic delivery modes. TMS interaction is minimal compared to visual modes.

TMS in CCIP:

- **TMS Right:** Cycles sighting point (STPT/TGT → OA1 → OA2 → IP → RP → SP).
- **Other TMS directions:** Limited function. CCIP pipper is slaved to ballistic solution, not TMS-controllable.

TMS in CCRP:

- **TMS Right:** Cycles sighting point (same as CCIP).
- **TMS Up (with FCR SOI):** May command FTT on radar significant features near steerpoint for refined ranging.
- **Other TMS directions:** Limited function.

Operational context: CCIP/CCRP are primarily avionics-computed modes; pilot maneuvers aircraft to meet release parameters rather than manipulating TMS cues. TMS Right (sighting point cycle) is the primary hands-on input.

See Table ?? for CCIP/CCRP TMS actions.

1.5.5 TMS in HARM employment

HARM (AGM-88) targeting uses HTS (HARM Targeting System) pod and HAD (HARM Attack Display). TMS interaction is via HTS/HAD SOI.

TMS with HTS/HAD SOI:

- **TMS Up:** Designates emitter on HAD as target. HARM seeker locks to designated emitter.
- **TMS Down:** Rejects designated emitter, returns to search.
- **TMS Right:** Steps through detected emitters on HAD (priority-based).

Operational context: HARM employment is highly specialized (SEAD/DEAD missions). TMS Up designates enemy radar emitters detected by HTS pod. Accurate emitter identification (via ELINT data loaded to HTS) is critical before TMS designation.

See Table ?? for HARM TMS actions.

[PLACEHOLDER: The following tables will be developed:]

1.6 TMS – Block and variant notes

TMS functionality is largely consistent across F-16 blocks simulated in Falcon BMS 4.38.1 (Block 40/42/50/52). However, specific subsystems and weapon integrations introduce minor variations.

1.6.1 Block-specific TMS differences

HMCS availability:

- **Block 50/52 (JHMCS):** Full HMCS integration. TMS Up >0.5s slaves cues to HMCS in A-G visual modes (DTOS, AGM-65 VIS, MARK). ACM BORE slaving to HMCS available.
- **Block 40/42 (no JHMCS):** HMCS-dependent TMS functions unavailable. TD box slaving, ACM BORE HMCS integration, MARK HMCS mode not functional. Pilots use HUD-only designation (aircraft maneuver + CURSOR).

Targeting Pod (TGP) availability:

- **TGP-equipped aircraft:** TMS Up with TGP SOI commands POINT track. AGM-65 handoff via TGP available.
- **Non-TGP aircraft:** TMS commands route to FCR or WPN page. No TGP POINT track, no visual target handoff to Maverick via pod.

HTS (HARM Targeting System) pod:

- **HTS-equipped (SEAD loadout):** TMS commands route to HAD when HAD is SOI. Emitter designation/rejection via TMS Up/Down.
- **Non-HTS aircraft:** HARM employment limited to pre-briefed mode or self-protect mode. No hands-on emitter designation via TMS.

1.6.2 IFF (AIFF) configuration

- **AIFF-equipped:** TMS Left activates SCAN/LOS interrogation in A-A and A-G.
- **Non-AIFF aircraft:** TMS Left has no function. IFF limited to automatic interrogation (not hands-on controllable).

1.6.3 AGM-65L (Laser Maverick) specifics

AGM-65L uses semi-active laser guidance. TMS Up sequence similar to AGM-65D/G, but requires:

- **Laser designation:** TGP or buddy aircraft must lase target throughout missile time-of-flight.
- **Laser code match:** Missile must be programmed with correct PRF code (via SMS page) before TMS Up designation.

See Dash-34 AGM-65L chapter and BMS Training Mission 27 for AGM-65L-specific procedures.

1.6.4 Training mission recommendations by block

- **Block 50/52 (JHMCS):** Missions 25 (DTOS with HMCS), 27 (AGM-65 VIS with HMCS).
- **Block 40/42 (no JHMCS):** Missions 24 (CCIP/CCRP), 26 (TGP employment), focus on HUD-only designation techniques.
- **All blocks:** Mission 18 (BARCAP) for A-A TMS mastery (FCR modes, TWS, ACM).